HPS ImpactPay Africa Hackathon 2026

Student Guidelines

Application deadline: Monday, 9 November 2026

1. About the Hackathon

The HPS ImpactPay Africa Hackathon invites Al Akhawayn University students to develop innovative electronic payment services that address real-world problems and create a positive impact across Africa.

Working in multidisciplinary teams, you will take on the role of fintech founders. Your task is to identify a problem, design a payment solution, develop a business model, build a prototype, and pitch your idea to a jury.

2. The Challenge

If your team were a fintech startup, what new payment service would you launch to create the greatest positive impact for people, businesses, and society?

Your solution should address a meaningful payment-related problem and meet the needs of a clearly identified group of customers.

You may explore areas such as:

- Financial inclusion and access to financial services
- Cybersecurity and secure digital payments
- Digital identity
- Merchant services
- Artificial intelligence in payments
- Cross-border payments
- Digital currencies and blockchain-based services
- Sustainable commerce

These are examples; you may propose another idea related to the future of payments.

3. Team Roles and Responsibilities

Each team should divide responsibilities according to its members' skills. The roles below are areas of responsibility to help teams organise their work.

- **Financial & Market Analyst – Market research, competitor analysis, business model, and go-to-market strategy.**
- **Product & Customer Experience Manager – User needs, customer journey, value proposition, and UX/UI.**
- **Technology & Innovation Lead – Technical architecture, prototype development, and innovation.**
- **Risk, Security & Compliance Officer – Security, fraud prevention, privacy, compliance, and impact assessment.**

4. What Your Team Must Develop

Your solution should address the following eight areas:

1. **Identify a meaningful problem:** Explain the payment-related problem and why it matters.
2. **Select a target market:** Identify your intended customers and their needs.
3. **Conduct market and competitor analysis:** Research existing services and identify opportunities for improvement.
4. **Design a differentiated payment service:** Explain how your solution works and what makes it distinctive.
5. **Build and demonstrate a prototype:** Show how the proposed service would work in practice.
6. **Define a viable business model:** Explain how the service could operate and remain sustainable.
7. **Address security, regulation, and responsible technology:** Consider user protection, data security, and relevant regulatory requirements.
8. **Demonstrate measurable positive impact:** Explain the benefits your solution could create and how you would measure them.

5. How to Apply

All teams must submit their applications by **9 November 2026**.

Follow these steps:

1. Complete the team application form with the requested information about your team and its members.
2. Prepare a team video that introduces your team and your prototype. Get creative with it!
3. Upload the video through the application form.

4. Check that all required fields are complete.
5. Submit your application before the deadline.

Application form: HPS ImpactPay Africa Hackathon Team Registration Form – Fill out form

Ready to make an impact?

Bring your ideas, collaborate with students from different disciplines, and develop a payment solution that could make a meaningful difference across Africa. Also, get a chance to win amazing cash prizes and get noticed by HPS for their final-year internship program.

Cash prizes for the winning teams are as follows:

1st: 20,000 MAD

2nd: 10,000 MAD

3rd: 4000 MAD

Audience Choice: 3000 MAD

Apply by 9 November 2026!